

7 Cs of Effective Communication

“True ease in writing comes from art, not chance;
As those move easiest who have learned to dance”

-Alexander Pope

With ever increasing competition in the market, companies need to stay on top with their products and services. They are also required to maintain a healthy and congenial relations with their clientele. While writing certainly is one of the most important skills to be had, merely with the help of writing, it is not always possible to close the deal as you may not be physically present to seal the deal successfully in business. Hence, companies require workforce that are not only good at writing, but also are impeccable in other forms of communication.

Think of how often you communicate with people during the day. You write emails, facilitate meetings, participate in conference calls, create reports, devise presentations, debate with your colleagues... the list goes on. We can spend almost our entire day communicating. So, it stands to reason that communicating clearly and effectively can boost productivity. The following 7 Cs of writing in specific, but generally applied to and used in all kinds of communication situations, are certainly going to help you in honing your communication skills.

C- Clarity

Acquiring clarity in communication – be it speaking, reading, listening or writing - is the most daunting (challenging) task a one faces in the beginning. A good communicator has to be absolutely clear with regard to the purpose of the communication and put in his/her best efforts towards fulfilling the same. There should prevail clarity of thought. No vagueness or confusion should prevail during the process. The selection of words then should lead to clearly defining the purpose and achieving the desired goal. Many writers have presented their thoughts with utmost conviction and clarity of thought. Though the style they chose was very different and unheard-of but they succeeded in producing the desired result since they were pristine clear with their objective of writing.

One such example is the female author writing for Feminist movement, Ms. Helen Sixous. She penned down a unique kind of essay where she just gives a long list of seemingly opposite words. She never wanted to follow in the footsteps of male writers, so she gave a completely novel spin to the style of essay. Of course, the list presented was quite thought provoking and is considered to be the biggest ever representatives of Feminism.

C- Courtesy

Give respect and get respect. Showing gratitude or respect towards your audience or readers is priceless and a must are to be had. A writer or communicator has to consider the feeling of their audience and select their words accordingly. Many a times in our communication, we don't mind our words and controversies follow. Never use certain taboo words and offensive comments which might lead to uproar and commotion. 'Females are subservient to males', 'Jews are greedy' and many more such comments will surely put you in the bad books of your audience/readers. The very famous example is that of Salman Rushdie who forgot to regard the emotions of people and subsequently had to be subjected to very hostile reception of one of his books 'The Satanic Verses'. The book still observes a ban in India over public buying or selling.

C- Correctness

Grammatical correctness is one of the fundamental requirements. You should be able to identify and use punctuations and different parts of speech correctly in your writing. Not only grammatical correctness but moral correctness too has its lion's share in shaping the personality of a journalist. Always highlight thing in your writing which can testify for your morality. Your morals have got to be impeccable. In your communication, you should try not to be prejudiced against or biased towards a particular cast, creed, religion or group. Nor should you try to flatter one particular section of society in order to earn their goodwill or favour. This might earn you a short-lived popularity and publicity but if your morals are corrupt, this publicity and fame won't stay with you forever.

C- Conciseness

*"Words are like leaves, and where they most abound;
Much fruit of sense beneath is rarely found"*

-Alexander Pope

Exercising conciseness or economy of words is a vital need for today's communication. Nobody is interested in wordy statements. Be verbal and not verbose. Use words to make things clear rather than creating a maze for your readers to confuse them. Be crisp and precise. Use language that is simple and easy to follow. Avoid circumlocution and beating around the bush. It's better to complete a letter or a news article with fewer but meaningful words rather than making it a lengthy and drab treatise conveying nothing fruitful. Even in the sport of cricket, economical bowlers are valued and preferred to those bowlers who are more expensive in terms of conceding runs per over. So always use shorter and meaningful sentences to create an elegant and newsworthy story that not only attracts the readers but will sell your story to the mass.

C- Concrete

To attain the Concreteness in communication, use specific facts and figures and choose image building words. It means that message should be specific instead of general. Misunderstanding of words creates problems for both parties (sender and receiver). When you talk to your client always use facts and figures instead of generic or irrelevant information.

For example:

Instead of using...	Use
We need a large office space	We need at least 10,000 square feet
Substantial discounts	Discount of 20%
Sold a good number of books	Sold 25,300 books
Student CMAT scores in 2018 are higher than 2019	In 2018, the CMAT scores averaged 600; by 2019 they had risen to 625.

C- Coherence:

Coherence refers to the clear and logical linking of ideas in a paragraph. *Coherence refers to the way ideas are linked at a paragraph level.* Without appropriate coherence in the sentences contributing meaning to the **topic sentence** a paragraph becomes ineffective. In order to achieve coherence, one must have the knowledge of cohesive devices, and this includes linking words, transitional tags, unity of paragraph, and adequate development.

For example: The technical description of a process describes how something works. The description begins with general information about the overall function of the process. The technical description has proceeds to the specific materials or skills required. (**Monotonous repetition.**)

The above paragraph doesn't seem coherent. The better version should read like: *The technical description of a process describes how something works, beginning with the general information about the overall function of the process, and proceeds to the specific materials or skills required.*

C- Complete:

Completeness refers to adhering all the above listed Cs. If you follow in your communication all the above-mentioned Cs, your communication automatically progresses towards achieving completeness in an organic manner. It would be apt to conclude with the words of Sir Francis Bacon who once said:

Reading Maketh a Full Man, Conversation, a ready man; Writing an Exact Man.

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